Resources & Support

Learn · Support · Advance Awareness
Understanding · Action · Community

📚 OFFICIAL & LOCAL US RESOURCES

- **Fairfax CSB Entry Point (703-324-4400)**: Primary county intake for early intervention. No SSN required.
- **Infant & Toddler Connection (Fairfax ITC)**: Early intervention ages 0-3. Free screenings; sliding-scale therapies.
- **Child Find (FCPS)**: Free developmental screenings for ages 20 months-5 years.
- **CDC "Learn the Signs. Act Early"**: Free milestone checklists and monitoring tools.
- **Autism Speaks 100-Day Kit**: Family guides and toolkits available in Chinese.
- 📞 **ASNV: (703) 537-9487** Education programs, webinars, and local support groups

📬 CONTACT & PRESENTATIONS

- Email: ezhengva@gmail.com
- Website: emmaz-sv.github.io/early-autism-awareness
- Free bilingual presentations for schools, clinics, and community groups

Scan for bilingual site
扫码访问双语网站
emmaz-sv.github.io/early-autism-awareness

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Sources: CDC, NIH, FCPS Child Find, Fairfax ITC

Early Autism Awareness Project



Our Mission

Emma Zheng · Early Autism Awareness Project

Empowering Chinese-speaking immigrant families with early autism awareness, helping parents recognize early warning signs, and guiding them to accessible local screening and intervention services.

🧠 Critical Brain Development Window

Ages 18-36 months are the most decisive window for childhood neurodevelopment. Early screening and timely intervention improve long-term communication, social, and adaptive outcomes.

Project Footprint: Chinese-speaking families across the DMV · Bilingual community education · Free downloadable resources

Early Signs & Red Flags

Core Milestones (Ages 12–36 Months)

👀 Limited Eye Contact	👆 No Pointing to Show
💬 Delayed Speech	🔁 Repetitive Behaviors
🧸 No Pretend Play	📢 Sensory Sensitivities

⚠️ **"Golden Rule" (Any Age):** Any regression or loss of speech, babbling, eye contact, gestures, or social skills at any age requires immediate evaluation by a pediatrician.

🧩 SOCIAL & PLAY MILESTONES

12 Months: Does not respond to name · Does not play interactive games (peek-a-boo)

15 Months: Does not bring or show toys to parents to share excitement

18–24 Months: Does not point to show interest · Does not imitate actions · No pretend play

Behavioral Patterns: Hand-flapping, rocking, spinning · Extreme distress at everyday sounds or lights

Joint Attention Delays: Does not point to direct an adult's attention or look when an adult points.



🧩 Multidimensional Spectrum Wheel

Autism is a broad spectrum where developmental domains vary independently. Each child forms a unique profile, highlighting strengths while guiding tailored support.

📋 4 STEPS TO SEEK SUPPORT

1. **Observe & Track:** Note specific red flags, track behaviors, and review milestones using validated checklists.
2. **Talk to Your Pediatrician:** Request an M-CHAT-R/F screener at well-child visits; share your observations.
3. **Comprehensive Assessment:** Moderate or high risk prompts referral to developmental pediatrics or early intervention.
4. **Start Early Intervention:** Contact Fairfax ITC (ages 0–3) or FCPS Child Find (20 months–5 years). Screenings are free; no official diagnosis or SSN required to begin.

❓ MISCONCEPTIONS & CLINICAL FACTS

MYTH

"Children who can speak cannot have autism."

FACT

Autism is a broad spectrum. Many autistic children speak fluently but need support with social reciprocity, nonverbal cues, or sensory regulation.

MYTH

"The child is young; let us wait and see if they outgrow it."

FACT

Ages 18–36 months are the golden intervention window. Waiting delays critical support during the brain's most adaptable phase.

MYTH

"Autism is caused by cold parenting or vaccines."

FACT

Autism is an innate neurodevelopmental difference. Decades of research refute links to parenting styles or vaccines.

Autism is an innate neurodevelopmental difference, unrelated to parenting or vaccines. Early identification unlocks a child's highest potential.